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‘It’s a big step forward over what we had in the past and what other states have done.’

EILEEN APPELBAUM,
co-director for the Center for
Economic and Policy Research

Law limits private equity in health care

Legislators take lesson in fallout from Steward

By Jessica Bartlett
and Catherine Carlock

GLOBE STAFF

After the pillaging of one of Massachusetts’ largest health systems and the subsequent closure of two of its hospitals here, state lawmakers have agreed on one thing: never again.

A law signed this month by Governor Maura Healey is being touted as a first-in-the-nation effort to monitor and rein in private equity in the hospital industry, and to prevent the sort of profiteering that critics say contributed in recent years to the financial collapse of Steward Health Care, the loss of hospitals in Dorchester and Ayer and at least 15 patient deaths.

And though the law does not block private equity involvement in Massachusetts health care, it is being hailed as an unprecedented foundation for future reform here and elsewhere, and key to preventing a repeat of the Steward debacle.

“The Massachusetts bill has a lot of weaknesses but it’s a big step forward over what we had in the past and what other states have done,” said Eileen Appelbaum, co-director for the Center for Economic and Policy Research, a Washington, D.C.-based think tank. “And it’s a message to other states — hey, you can regulate.”

It does this in part by targeting one of the primary ways that Steward’s owners extracted money from the system — a major contributing factor in its collapse last year in Massachusetts — by prohibiting hospitals from selling their primary campus to outside investors.

The Massachusetts law also accomplishes what many states have tried and so far failed to do — establish ongoing financial monitoring and oversight of investors in a health care provider.

Under the law, investors with as little as 10 percent equity will be required to participate in the state’s annual health care oversight hearings and file ownership and governance in-

HOSPITALS, Page A10

New fear for migrants here legally

Trump directive says users of pair of Biden-era programs could face deportation



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Junior Bruce talked with his daughter, Jonesna, 4, at their home in Dorchester. The family used the CBP One app to enter the United States.

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
and Samantha J. Gross

GLOBE STAFF

Thousands of migrants who arrived in Massachusetts legally in recent years could now be at risk of potential deportation under new Trump administration directives, according to an internal government memo shared with the Globe.

The memo appears to give immigration officials the authority to remove people from the country who had entered the US legally, specifically under two Biden-era programs under which migrants have been given permission to temporarily work and live in the country. In some cases, the

memo indicates that authorities could put these immigrants on a fast-track to deportation, which might prevent some from appearing before an immigration judge to fight their removal.

“What [President] Trump is looking to do is go back in time and take away the parole status from immigrants and their families that they’ve been relying on,” said Heather Yountz, senior immigration staff attorney for the Massachusetts Law Reform Institute.

Humanitarian parole was granted to migrants who entered the United States legally under the two Biden-administration programs — the CBP One application that allowed migrants to schedule

appointments for entry, and a separate initiative letting in certain migrants fleeing Cuba, Nicaragua, Venezuela, and Haiti. They are allowed to live and work lawfully for two years while applying for longer-term status.

Both of those Biden initiatives were ended by Trump soon after he was sworn in this week. And in its new memo, the administration said it had the right to apply its enforcement discretion to carry out parole terminations as authorities saw fit.

A Trump spokesperson did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

DEPORTATIONS, Page A6

These officials stepped down rather than fend off a Trump firing

By Jim Puzzanghera

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — President Trump is reshaping the federal government, nominating new Cabinet secretaries, and restocking other political positions as is customary with a change of administration.

What is not customary is the departure of some top officials whose terms were designed to overlap presidencies to avoid politicizing their agencies. And unlike during Trump’s first term, they’ve made it easier for him to replace them by resigning instead of forcing a showdown over their jobs.

In May 2017, for example, Trump fired FBI Director James Comey fewer than four years into his 10-year term as he oversaw an investigation into Russian interference in the 2016 election and possible connections to Trump’s campaign. Faced with a similar fate, Comey’s replacement, Christopher Wray, opted to announce his resignation in December.

Early this month, Michael Barr, a vice chair of the Fed-

RESIGNATIONS, Page A7

‘What [President] Trump is looking to do is go back in time.’

HEATHER YOUNTZ,
senior immigration
staff attorney for the
Massachusetts Law
Reform Institute,
speaking of the new
directive



Pete Hegseth promised a “warrior culture.”

Senate confirms Hegseth — barely

Vance has to cast deciding vote

By Lisa Mascaro,
Mary Clare Jalonick,
and Farnoush Amiri

ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The Senate confirmed Pete Hegseth as the nation’s defense secretary Friday in a dramatic late-night vote, swatting back questions about his qualifications to lead the Pentagon amid allegations of heavy drinking and aggressive behavior toward women.

Rarely has a Cabinet nominee faced such wide-ranging concerns about his experience and behavior as Hegseth, particularly for such a high-profile role atop

the US military. But the Republican-led Senate was determined to confirm Hegseth, a former Fox News host

►While touring disaster sites, Trump mused about shutting down FEMA. **A2.**

and combat veteran who has vowed to bring a “warrior culture,” rounding out President Trump’s top national security Cabinet officials.

Vice President JD Vance cast the tie-breaking vote, unusual in the Senate for Cabinet nominees, who typically win wider support.

HEGSETH, Page A7

When Dry January is High January

Cannabis sellers see opportunity amid negative reports on alcohol

By Beth Teitell

GLOBE STAFF

It was a cold Monday night, but for Rashelys Castillo, the dash to the Fenway pot shop was worth it. Not only was New Dia dispensary giving free joints, but Castillo was doing Damp January, a forgiving version of Dry January, and a key part of her strategy involved using cannabis to help cut back on alcohol, or at least hard liquor.

“I just had a glass of wine,” Castillo, a self-described “social drinker,” admitted cheerfully. But that was 30 minutes ago, and here she was now, eager to recharge her Damp January — in an 11,200-square-foot dispensary, surrounded by sour strawberry gummies, Blue Zushi vapes, zero sugar fast-acting Root

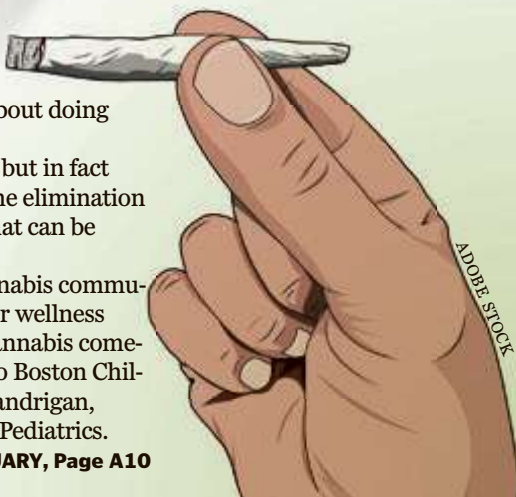
Beer syrups, and pot-themed socks.

Wait. What? Is it the world’s best loophole — you can get buzzed and *still* boast about doing Dry January?

Or, is it not a loophole at all, but in fact something entirely different: The elimination of an unhealthy habit for one that can be healthy?

The latter is the way the cannabis community positions it — “support your wellness goals,” reads one not-atypical cannabis come-on. But that’s not how it looks to Boston Children’s Hospital’s Christopher Landrigan, chief of the Division of General Pediatrics.

HIGH JANUARY, Page A10



ADOBE STOCK



Bright club

Saturday: Sunny, breezy.
High: 29-34. Low: 22-27.

Sunday: Partly sunny.
High: 38-43. Low: 22-27.

Sunrise: 7:04 Sunset: 4:49
Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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Hamas said that it would release four female soldiers held hostage for 15 months in Gaza, as part of an exchange for dozens of Palestinian prisoners laid out in its cease-fire agreement with Israel. **A4.**

Ukraine fired a large volley of exploding drones at Russia, in a barrage that set an oil refinery and pumping station on fire and briefly closed multiple airports. **A5.**

A 21-year-old Washington state woman was arrested in the fatal shooting of a US Border Patrol agent in Vermont earlier in the week. **B1.**

A jury acquitted New England Patriots safety Jabrill Peppers of charges that he assaulted a woman at his Braintree home in October. **B1.**